In our previous example, you should see right away that human communication simply won't scale and thus becomes a bottleneck. If the data engineers spend their days understanding lineage, they won't have time to speed up the platform. And every minute they spend on speeding up the platform becomes 10 times that speedup because the platform is used by multiple teams, up to a certain point.

X AS A SERVICE OBSERVED

The difference between collaboration/facilitation and X as a service might be quite familiar to you. We have seen a lot of data organizations try to switch to an X as a service collaboration model lately.

These data organizations have data teams that are centralized and tasked with both ingesting data sources as well as modeling them out and providing reports and dashboards on top of them. Usually, the collaboration between report requesters and the central data team is one of *collaboration*: the requester asks for a report, the central data team creates it, and then the requester asks for additional changes.

However, reporting and dashboarding simply don't scale for some of these organizations. They then try to make the data team into a platform team with a bunch of analysts and analytics engineers spread out across the company.

The central data team becomes a "platform team" by focusing on just the data ingestion part and possibly on modeling a few key data pieces. On the other side, then, analysts and analytics engineers will pick up this data and produce reports and dashboards on top of it.

The interaction model here changes substantially. The central data team will have to do some serious product management by ingesting and providing datasets that are commonly used across the user base and align with the future direction of the company. If they are doing this well, they manage the transition to a *data-as-a-service model* in their interaction with other parts of the company.

However, as you might've guessed, this collaboration mode, which is typical for a platform team, also requires a certain level of matureness, especially in